experiences of Nathu La in 1967, Sumdorongchu in 1986–87, Doklam in 2017, and Ladakh after 2020 show that the application of military force along with complementary diplomatic efforts, can be used to counter Chinese military adventurism.

In its region, India will continue to face challenges. While India cannot always block Chinese investment in its neighbourhood, it can try to provide viable alternatives. This has involved stepping up aid and lending, including emergency financial resources and infrastructure investment. India has also pursued joint or coordinated projects with partners, including the United States and Japan, in South, Southeast, and West Asia.

Beyond arming, India will also have to play economic hardball, while advocating for reciprocal market access. While China dumps surplus materials in the Indian market, hurting Indian manufacturers, Indian firms have difficulty servicing Chinese companies, even in areas where they have comparative advantages. India will have to counter unfair Chinese trade practices, while continuing to advocate for greater and more equitable business opportunities. For example, in retaliation for China's actions on the border in 2020, India banned Chinese apps, screened Chinese involvement in public procurement, closely monitored Chinese investments, restricted Chinese media, and effectively disallowed Chinese vendors in 5G telecommunications infrastructure. [44] Indian concerns about China have also translated into digital and trade policies, including the notion of trusted geographies and complementary trade partners. Indeed, despite the large and continuing goods trade deficit, India may have done more than any other major economy to de-risk from China, particularly in critical and vulnerable sectors.

At the multilateral level, India and China have increasingly been competing or disagreeing at forums such as the United Nations and export control groups. Substantively, they have adopted different approaches to freedom of navigation and digital governance. India has joined China-led entities such as the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB), BRICS, and SCO, organizations that were established during at a more promising phase in India–China relations between 2009 and 2016. BRICS and the